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Fast-fitting decorative assembly with finial

Abstract

A decorative assembly having a finial element and a fastening element configured to couple with the finial element, where the fastening element may be mounted to a surface such as a wall. The finial element may come in various shapes and sizes, including without limitation ball shape, end cap, cut acrylic, tiered glass, to name a few. The decorative assembly may be utilized for decorative purposes accenting the end of objects such as drapery or curtain rods.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application claims benefit from U.S. Provisional Patent Application Ser. No. 63/375,138, filed Sep. 9, 2022, which is incorporated by reference in its entirety.

FIELD OF THE INVENTION

(1) The present invention generally relates to decorative assemblies and specifically, to finial assemblies that accent the top or end of an object in order to provide darkening and/or privacy in a room in which the object is mounted.

BACKGROUND

(2) Finials may be utilized as decorative ends of drapery or curtain rods and may also be utilized for non-decorative functions, such as keeping drapery or curtains from sliding off the end of a rod. Finials are decorative end pieces that may fit at ends of a drapery rod to give it a finished, ornamental look. Finials may be provided in many styles and finishes to coordinate with the style of a room in which they are utilized. For example, the finials may be made of metal or wood and may be screwed into the ends of the drapery or curtain rods.

(3) When considering the use of drapery or curtain rods that are intended to provide for darkening or privacy of a room, there is a challenge when it is desired to be able to attach and detach the rod for easy and efficient movement of the rod when the darkening or privacy of a room is desired on a non-permanent basis but still provide an ornamental look. When drapery or curtain rods are mounted directly to a wall, installation and subsequent attachment and detachment of the rod is complicated and inefficient, thereby not facilitating utilization of the rod and corresponding finials as intended and making the use of finials undesirable for either decorative or non-decorative functions. The present invention provides a drapery or curtain rod that incorporates a finial that is both uncomplicated and efficient and such that the rod with one or more finials may be attached and detached for easy and efficient movement.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(4) The following presents a summary of the invention in order to provide a basic understanding of some aspects of the invention. This summary is not an extensive overview of the invention. It is intended to neither identify key or critical elements of the invention nor delineate the scope of the invention. The purpose of this summary is to present some concepts of the invention in a simplified form as a prelude to the more detailed description that is presented subsequently.

(5) Disclosed is a decorative assembly according to embodiments of the present invention. The decorative assembly may be utilized to provide darkening and/or privacy of a room and also is also easily attached and detached for easy and efficient movement of the decorative assembly.

(6) In one embodiment, the decorative assembly includes a finial element and a fastening element configured to couple with the finial element. The fastening element may be mounted to a surface, such as a wall or inside a window such that a curtain or drapery mounted on the rod on which the finial element is mounted hangs over the window to provide darkening and/or privacy. The finial

element may embody various shapes and sizes. The finial element may have a shape, such as a ball shape or an end cap, and may be cut acrylic or tiered glass as well as other shapes. The decorative assembly may be utilized for decorative purposes by accenting the end of objects, such as drapery or curtain rods.

(7) Some of the benefits of the present invention include ease of installation to provide darkening and/or privacy of a room without sacrificing the aesthetics of a traditional decorative rod set and to facilitate easy detachment and movement to other windows or rooms. In addition, the decorative assembly including the finial element and the fastening element may have lower material cost than traditional decorative rod sets and are easier to install since they are fast-fitting and require no brackets or drilling to install and uninstall. The present invention further provides an alternative to wrap-rods or tension rods used in a traditional decorative rod set.

(8) These and other features and advantages will be apparent from the following detailed description, the associated drawings, and appended claims. It is to be understood that both the foregoing general description and the subsequent detailed description are only explanatory and are not restrictive of aspects of the invention as claimed.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) These and other features, aspects, and advantages of the present invention will be better understood with reference to the following description and appended claims in view of the drawings where:

(2) FIG. 1 is a front view of a decorative assembly according to an embodiment of the present invention.

(3) FIG. 2 is a perspective view of a fastening element for a decorative assembly according to an embodiment of the present invention.

(4) FIG. 3(a) is a perspective detached view of a decorative assembly according to an embodiment of the present invention.

(5) FIG. 3(b) is a top-down view of the decorative assembly in FIG. 3(a).

(6) FIG. 4(a) is a perspective view of a decorative assembly according to an embodiment of the present invention that may be utilized for windows encompassing two perpendicular walls.

(7) FIG. 4(b) is a top view of the decorative assembly in FIG. 4(a).

(8) FIG. 4(c) is a perspective detached view of the corner wall bracket of the decorative assembly in FIG. 4(a).

(9) FIG. 4(d) is a perspective detached view of the corner wall bracket in FIG. 4(c).

(10) FIG. 5(a) is a perspective detached view of a fastening element of a decorative assembly according to an embodiment of the present invention.

(11) FIG. 5(b) is a connected view of the fastening element in FIG. 5(a).

(12) FIG. 5(c) is a perspective detached view of another embodiment of the fastening element in FIG. 5(a).

(13) FIG. 6(a) is a perspective detached view of a wrap-rod utilizing the same base as a finial bracket according to an embodiment of the present invention.

(14) FIG. 6(b) is an assembled view of the wrap-rod in FIG. 6(a).

(15) FIG. 7 is a front view of a decorative assembly according to another embodiment of the present invention that may be utilized inside a window.

(16) FIG. 8 is front view of a decorative assembly according to another embodiment of the present invention that may be utilized above a window in close proximity to a perpendicular wall.

(17) FIG. 9(a) is a perspective detached view of a finial assembly that has a one-piece finial and mounting bracket according to another embodiment of the present invention.

(18) FIG. 9(b) is an assembled view of the finial assembly in FIG. 9(a).

(19) FIG. 9(c) is a perspective detached view of another embodiment of the finial assembly in FIGS. 9(a) and 9(b).

(20) FIG. 9(d) is an assembled view of the finial assembly in FIG. 9(c).

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

(21) The present invention is now described with reference to the drawings, wherein like reference numerals refer to like elements throughout. In the following description, for purposes of explanation, numerous specific details are set forth in order to provide a thorough understanding of the present invention. However, the present invention may be practiced without any or only some of these specific details. In the figures, well-known structures and devices may be shown in block diagram form in order to facilitate describing the present invention.

(22) FIG. 1 is front view of a decorative assembly **100** according to an embodiment of the present invention. As shown in FIG. 1, the decorative assembly **100** includes a finial element **112** and a rod **114**. Although the finial element **112** is shown in FIG. 1 with a round end cap, the finial element may be various shapes and sizes.

(23) The finial element **112** may be secured to the rod **114** via a screw element (see FIGS. 3(a) and 3(b)). Alternatively, the finial element **112** may be secured to the rod **114** via other fasteners, such as glue.

(24) Once secured, the finial element **112** and the rod **114** may be secured to a wall (See FIGS. 4(a) and 4(b)) via a fastening element (see FIG. 2) and suitable wall fasteners, such as nails, screws or wall plugs. Drapery or curtains **116** may be mounted to the rod **114** via apertures.

(25) FIG. 2 is a perspective view of a fastening element for a decorative assembly according to an embodiment of the present invention. As shown in FIG. 2, the fastening element **200** includes a body **222** with a pair of hook elements **224** at a lower portion of the body **222**.

(26) An upper portion of the body **222** includes an opening **225** to receive a plate **226** having a pair of nails **228** extending therefrom. The plate **226** and the nails **228** may be configured to fasten to a wall. For example, the nails **228** may be securely fastened to stud portions of a wall. While nails **228** are shown in FIG. 2, it will be understood that other fasteners, such as removable screws or plugs, may also be utilized.

(27) Once mounted, such as when the nails **228** are securely embedded into a wall, the plate **226** may be securely flushed to the wall together with the body **222** of the fastening element **200**. Since forces are exerted by the nails **228** and the plate **226**, the body **222** will also be securely fastened to the wall, with the hook elements **224** extending upwardly and outwardly from the wall. The hook elements **224** may be utilized to receive a finial element **112**, such as that disclosed with regard to FIG. 1.

(28) FIG. 3(a) is a perspective view of a decorative assembly according to an embodiment of the present invention. FIG. 3(b) is a top-down view of the decorative assembly in FIG. 3(a).

(29) As shown in FIGS. 3(a) and 3(b), the decorative assembly **300** includes a finial element **112**, a rod **114** and a fastening element **200**, such as that disclosed with regard to FIGS. 1 and 2.

(30) The finial element **112** may be secured to the rod **114** via a screw element **316** as shown. For example, the finial element **112** may be screwed into the rod **114** by rotating the finial element **112** about the rod **114**. Although a screw element **316** is shown, it will be understood that other fasteners, such as plugs or pins, may also be utilized.

(31) While the end of the finial element **112** shown in FIGS. 3(a) and 3(b) has an oblong shape, it will be understood that the ends of the finial element **112** may be a variety of shapes and sizes. The finial element may have a shape, such as a ball shape or an end cap, and may be cut acrylic or tiered glass as well as other shapes. The decorative assembly **300** may be utilized for decorative purposes by accenting the end of objects, such as the rod **114** disclosed with regard to FIG. 1, with accompanying drapery or curtains.

(32) In the embodiment shown in FIGS. 3(a) and 3(b), the finial element **112** includes a recess **332**

and a plate **334**. As disclosed with regard to FIG. 2, the fastening element **200** may be securely mounted to a wall with the hook elements **224** extending upwardly and outwardly.

(33) In operation, the finial element **112** may be mounted to the wall fastening element **200**, with the hook elements **224** engaging the plate **334** and being received within the recess **332**. This allows the finial element **112** to be easily and quickly mounted on and removed from the wall fastening element **200**. The combination of the finial element **112** and the fastening element **200** collectively forms the decorative assembly **300**.

(34) The fastening element **200** may be initially secured to a wall, as disclosed with regard to FIG. 2. There may be a plurality of wall fastening elements **200** mounted to the wall depending on the length and weight of the rod **114**, as well as the weight of any drapery or curtains **116** (see FIG. 1) themselves (not shown).

(35) FIG. 4(a) is a perspective view of a decorative assembly according to an embodiment of the present invention that may be utilized for windows encompassing two perpendicular walls. FIG. 4(b) is a top view of the decorative assembly in FIG. 4(a). FIG. 4(c) is a perspective detached view of the corner wall bracket of the decorative assembly in FIG. 4(a). FIG. 4(d) is a perspective detached view of an alternate corner wall bracket in FIG. 4(c).

(36) As shown in FIGS. 4(a) and 4(b), when the decorative assembly **400** is installed in a corner window **452** that encompasses two perpendicular walls **450** with insufficient wall space for a finial element **112**, such as that disclosed with regard to FIG. 1, at each end of the decorative assembly **400**, the decorative assembly **430** includes two telescoping rods **114**, such as that disclosed with regard to FIG. 1, each of the two telescoping rods **114** having a finial element **112**, such as that disclosed with regard to FIG. 1, at one end as well as a corner wall bracket **452** at the other end with each corner wall bracket **452** attached to a wall **450** and via which the two telescoping rods **114** are attached to each other. Each finial element **112** is attached to a corresponding wall **450** utilizing a fastening element **200** (see FIG. 2). The wall corner bracket **452** facilitates installing the decorative assembly **430** in windows that do not have sufficient wall space at all sides.

(37) As shown in FIG. 4(c), the corner wall bracket **452** includes two end brackets **453** and a corner fastening element **454**. Each of the two end brackets **453** is inserted into the corner fastening element **454**.

(38) Each of the end brackets **453** includes an extending portion **455** and an extended end portion **456**. Each of the rods **114**, such as that disclosed with regard to FIG. 1, is mounted to one of the end brackets **453** by inserting the extending portion **455** into the rod **114**.

(39) The corner fastening element **454** includes two insertion portions **457** and at least one screw hole **458**. Each of the end brackets **453** is attached to the fastening element **454** by inserting the corresponding extended end portion **456** into one of the insertion portions **457** of the fastening element **454**. The fastening element **454** is attached to at least one of the walls **450** by inserting a screw **459** into at the least one screw hole **458**. The fastening element **454** may be fastened to one or both of the perpendicular walls **450**.

(40) As shown in FIG. 4(d), an alternate embodiment of the corner wall bracket **452** may be utilized when the decorative assembly **400** is installed inside a window that is too close to a perpendicular wall to utilize the fastening element **200** shown in FIG. 2. As shown in FIG. 4(d), the corner wall bracket **452** includes an end bracket **453** and a wall fastening element **454**, similar to that disclosed in FIG. 4(c).

(41) The end bracket **453** includes an extending portion **455** and an extended end portion **456**. The wall fastening element **454** includes an insertion portion **457** and a screw hole **458**. The end bracket **453** is attached to the fastening element **454** by inserting the end portion **456** into the insertion portion **457**. A rod, such as that disclosed with regard to FIG. 1, is mounted to the end bracket **453** by inserting the extended portion **455** into the rod.

(42) The wall fastening element **454** is attached to a wall **450** (see FIGS. 4(a) and 4(b)) by inserting a screw **459** into the screw hole **458**. Alternatively, the end bracket **454** may include nail holes **460**

instead of, or in addition to, the screw hole **458**, into which nails **462** are inserted in order to attach the wall fastening element **454** to a wall **450** (see FIGS. **4(a)** and **4(b)**).

(43) FIG. **5(a)** is a perspective detached view of a fastening element of a decorative assembly according to an embodiment of the present invention. FIG. **5(b)** is a connected view of the fastening element in FIG. **5(a)**. FIG. **5(c)** is a perspective detached view of another embodiment of the fastening element in FIG. **5(a)**.

(44) As shown in FIGS. **5(a)** and **5(b)**, the fastening element **520** is utilized to attach a finial element **112** that is attached to a rod **114**, such as that disclosed with regard to FIG. **1**, to a wall **450** (see FIGS. **4(a)** and **4(b)**). The fastening element **520** includes a finial bracket **522** and a wall bracket **524**. The finial element **112** includes an extending portion **555** that is utilized to attach the rod **114** to the finial element **112**.

(45) The finial bracket **522** includes an extended end portion **556**, similar to that disclosed with regard to FIGS. **4(c)** and **4(d)**, and is attached to the finial element **112**. The wall bracket **524** includes an insertion portion **557** and a screw hole **558** and is attached to a wall **450** (see FIGS. **4(a)** and **4(b)**) by insertion of a screw **529** into the screw hole **558** or, alternately, by nails or pins **559** inserted into holes **560** in the wall bracket **524**. The finial **112** with the rod **114** attached is then attached to the wall bracket **524** by inserting the extended end portion **556** of the finial bracket **522** into the insertion portion **557** of the wall bracket **524**.

(46) Although the wall bracket **524** shown in FIGS. **5(a)** and **5(b)** has a rectangular shape, it will be understood that the wall bracket **524** may be a variety of shapes and sizes, such as a square shape or round shape. As shown in FIG. **5(c)**, a wall bracket **525** is utilized in a similar manner as the wall bracket **524** disclosed with regard to FIGS. **5(a)** and **5(b)** but has a circular shape.

(47) FIG. **6(a)** is a perspective detached view of a wrap-rod utilizing the same base as a finial bracket according to an embodiment of the present invention. FIG. **6(b)** is an assembled view of the wrap-rod in FIG. **6(a)**.

(48) As shown in FIGS. **6(a)** and **6(b)**, the wrap-rod **620** has the finial element **112** shown in FIGS. **5(a)** and **5(b)** replaced with a wrap-rod element **612**. The wrap-rod element **612** is utilized to attach a rod **114**, such as that disclosed with regard to FIG. **1**, to a wall **450** (see FIGS. **4(a)** and **4(b)**). The wrap-rod **620** includes a wall bracket **625** and the wrap-rod element **612**, which is attached to the wall bracket **625**.

(49) The wrap-rod element **612** further includes an extending portion **655**, similar to that disclosed with regard to FIGS. **5(a)** and **5(b)**, that is utilized to attach the rod **114** to the wrap-rod element **612**. The wrap-rod element **612** includes an extended end portion **656**, similar to that disclosed with regard to FIGS. **4(c)** and **4(d)**. The wall bracket **625** includes an insertion portion **657** and a screw hole **658** and is attached to a wall **450** (see FIGS. **4(a)** and **4(b)**) by insertion of a screw **629** into the screw hole **658** or, alternatively, by nails or pins **659** inserted into holes **660** in the wall bracket **625**.

(50) FIG. **7** is a front view of a decorative assembly according to another embodiment of the present invention that may be utilized inside a window. As shown in FIG. **7**, when the decorative assembly **430**, such as that disclosed with regard to FIG. **1**, is installed inside a window **752** that has sufficient wall space for a finial element **112** at each end of the decorative assembly **430**, the decorative assembly **430** includes a telescoping rod **114**, such as that disclosed with regard to FIG. **1**, having a finial element **112**, such as that disclosed with regard to FIG. **1**, at each end. Each finial element **112** is attached to a corresponding wall inside the window **752** via either a fastening element **200** (see FIG. **2**).

(51) FIG. **8** is front view of a decorative assembly according to another embodiment of the present invention that may be utilized above a window in close proximity to a perpendicular wall. As shown in FIG. **8**, when the decorative assembly **430**, such as that disclosed with regard to FIG. **1**, is installed in above window **852** that has insufficient wall space for a finial element **112** at each end of the decorative assembly **430**, the decorative assembly **430** includes a telescoping rod **114**, such as that disclosed with regard to FIG. **1**, having a finial element **112**, such as that disclosed with

regard to FIG. 1, at one end and a non-finial connecting element **812** at the other end. The finial element **112** is attached to a corresponding wall above the window **852** via a fastening element **200** (see FIG. 2). The non-finial connecting element **812** is attached to a corresponding wall at the end of the window **812** via either a fastening element **200** (see FIG. 2) or the telescoping function of the rod **114** enhanced by an internal spring device or other device (not shown) to hold the corresponding rod **114** against the corresponding wall **450**.

(52) FIG. 9(a) is a perspective detached view of a finial assembly that has a one-piece finial and mounting bracket according to another embodiment of the present invention. FIG. 9(b) is an assembled view of the finial assembly in FIG. 9(a). FIG. 9(c) is a perspective detached view of another embodiment of the finial assembly in FIG. 9(a). FIG. 9(d) is an assembled view of the finial assembly in FIG. 9(c).

(53) As shown in FIGS. 9(a) and 9(b), the finial assembly **900** includes a finial element **912** and a mounting bracket **921**. The mounting bracket **921** includes an extended end portion **956**, similar to that disclosed with regard to FIGS. 5(a), 5(b) and 5(c), and is attached to the finial element **912** such that a one-piece a one-piece finial and mounting bracket is formed.

(54) The finial element **912** includes an insertion portion **955**, similar to that disclosed with regard to FIGS. 5(a) and 5(b). The extended end portion **956** of the mounting bracket **921** includes at least two nail holes **960**.

(55) As shown in FIGS. 9(a) and 9(b), the finial assembly **900** is utilized to attach the finial element **912**, which is attached to at least one rod **914**, similar to that disclosed with regard to FIG. 1, to a wall **450** (see FIGS. 4(a) and 4(b)) via the insertion portion **955**. The extended end portion **956** is attached to a wall **450** (see FIGS. 4(a) and 4(b)) by insertion of nails **959** into the at least two nail holes **960**.

(56) The one-piece finial and mounting bracket design of the finial assembly **900** provides for fast and easy detachable-mounting to the wall **450**. The detachable-mounting may be facilitated by a screw-in or plug-in process between the finial assembly **900** and the at least one rod **914** via a telescoping function of the at least one rod **914**.

(57) As shown in FIGS. 9(c) and 9(d), the finial assembly **901** utilizes hidden screw-in and/or fast-fit nails. The finial assembly **901** is similar to that disclosed with regard to FIGS. 9(a) and 9(b) with a mounting bracket **921**. The mounting bracket **921** includes a screw hole **958** and an extended end portion **957**.

(58) The finial element **912** is attached to a rod **915**, such as that disclosed with regard to FIG. 1, by inserting the extended end portion **957** into the rod **915**. The finial assembly **901** is utilized to attach the finial element **912**, which is attached to a rod **915**, to a wall **450** (see FIGS. 4(a) and 4(b)). The mounting bracket **921** is attached to the wall **450** by insertion a screw **929** into the screw hole **958** or, alternately, by insertion of nails **959** into the at least two nail holes **960**. The one-piece finial and mounting bracket design of the finial assembly **901** provides for fast and easy detachable-mounting to the wall **450**.

(59) While example embodiments according to the present invention have been particularly shown and described, it will be understood by those skilled in the art that various changes in form and details may be made therein without departing from the scope of the embodiment according to the present invention encompassed by the appended claims. For example, other useful implementations could be achieved if steps of the disclosed techniques were performed in a different order and/or if components in the disclosed systems were combined in a different manner and/or replaced or supplemented by other components. Accordingly, other implementations are within the scope of the disclosure.

Claims

1. A decorative assembly, comprising: at least one rod on which a curtain or drapery is mounted; at least one finial element configured to attach to at least a first end of the at least one rod; at least one fastening element configured to attach to the finial element and to detachably attach to a surface such that the curtain or drapery hangs over at least one window and at least partially blocks at least a view into the at least one window or light through the at least one window; wherein the at least one fastening element comprises a body having a pair of hook elements at a lower portion of the body, and an opening at an upper portion of the body, the opening configured to receive a plate having a pair of nails extending therefrom such that the at least one fastening element is configured to attach to a wall; wherein the at least one fastening element is further configured to fasten to the wall with the pair of hook elements extending upwardly and outwardly; wherein the at least one finial element comprises a recess and a plate and is configured to attach to the at least one fastening element via the pair of hook elements engaging the plate and being received within the recess such that the at least one finial element is mounted on and removed from the at least one fastening element: wherein the at least one finial element and at least one fastening element form the decorative assembly: the at least one rod comprises at least two rods on each of which a curtain or drapery is mounted; the at least one finial element comprises a first finial element configured to attach to a first end of a first of the at least two rods; a second finial element configured to attach to a first end of a second of the at least two rods; a corner wall bracket configured to attach to a second end of the first of the at least two rods and to a second end of the second of the at least two rods such that the first of the at least two rods and the second of at least two rods are attached to each other, the corner wall bracket configured to attach to a wall between two perpendicular windows; the at least one fastening element comprises a first fastening element configured to attach the first of the at least two rods to a first wall other than the wall between the two perpendicular windows such that the first of the at least two rods is detachably attached to the first wall; and a second fastening element configured to attach the second of the at least two rods to a second wall other than the wall between the two perpendicular windows such that the second of the at least two rods is detachably attached to the second wall; a third fastening element configured to couple with the first finial element, the third fastening element configured to detachably mount to a first surface such that the first of the at least two rods hangs over at least a first of the two perpendicular windows and at least partially blocks at least a view into the at least the first of the two perpendicular windows or light through the at least the first of the two perpendicular windows; and a fourth fastening element configured to couple with the second finial element, the fourth fastening element configured to detachably mount to a second surface such that the second of the at least two rods hangs over at least a second of the two perpendicular windows and at least partially blocks at least a view into the at least the second of the two perpendicular windows or light through the at least the second of the two perpendicular windows.

2. The decorative assembly of claim 1, wherein: the corner wall bracket is utilized to attach the decorative assembly to the wall between the two perpendicular windows and comprises two end brackets and a corner fastening element; each of the two end brackets comprises an extended end portion configured to attach to the corner fastening element; each of the two end brackets further comprises an extending portion configured to attach to one of the at least two rods; the corner fastening element comprises two insertion portions, each configured to attach to the extended end portion of one of the two end brackets; and each of the two end brackets is attached to the fastening element by inserting the corresponding extended end portion into one of the two insertion portions of the corner fastening element.

3. The decorative assembly of claim 1, wherein: the wall corner bracket is utilized to attach the decorative assembly to the wall between the two perpendicular windows and comprises two end brackets and two fastening elements; each of the two fastening elements comprises an extended end portion configured to attach to one of the two end brackets; each of the two end brackets is

configured to attach to one of the two fastening elements; each of the two end brackets comprises an extending portion configured to attach to one of the at least two rods; each of the two fastening elements comprises an insertion portion configured to attach to the extended end portion of one of the two fastening elements; each of the two end brackets is attached to the corresponding fastening element by inserting the corresponding extended end portion into the insertion portion of the corresponding fastening element.
